

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 8  
 ♥ Q 10 5 4 2  
 ♦ 7 3  
 ♣ A 3

♠ 9 7 5  
 ♥ J 7  
 ♦ K Q 8  
 ♣ K J 9 8 2



♠ K 6 2  
 ♥ K 6 3  
 ♦ 9 5 4 2  
 ♣ 7 6 5

♠ A 4 3  
 ♥ A 9 8  
 ♦ A J 10 6  
 ♣ Q 10 4

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
| Pass         | 3NT          |             | 1NT          |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 3NT by South |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♥ 4    |              |             |              |

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥ 4.

This is a close call. The top of your ♠ honor sequence is very tempting, but even when you find partner with the ♠ K you can still only establish three ♠ winners to go with your ♣ A. Unfortunately, that's not enough to defeat the contract.

Leading a ♥ from your 5-card suit is riskier, but it has the potential of setting up an additional winner. In this hand, as you see, the ♥ lead gets you 4 ♥ winners to go with your ♣ A.

**Board 2**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 4  
 ♥ 9 8 2  
 ♦ A 10 5 3  
 ♣ A J 6 2

♠ K J 7 5

♥ A K 6 5

♦ 8 7 4 2

♣ 5



♠ Q 10 6 2

♥ 10

♦ Q J 9 6

♣ Q 10 9 3

♠ A 9 3

♥ Q J 7 4 3

♦ K

♣ K 8 7 4

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       |      | 1 ♥   |
| Pass         | 1 ♠   | Pass | 2 ♣   |
| Pass         | 4 ♥   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 4 ♥ by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♥ 9    |       |      |       |

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4 ♥

Underleading an Ace against a suit contract is the absolute worst opening lead in Bridge. A careful look at this hand shows just how bad it can turn out.

And leading from a doubleton in a suit the opponents have bid is almost as bad.

So by process of elimination you lead a trump, probably the ♥ 9.

And when South plays ♣s, (preparing to ruff in dummy), you will win and play another trump. Even if South guesses the ♠s correctly he will not be able to make the contract.

**Board 3**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 6  
 ♥ Q J 10 7 3  
 ♦ 10 5 3  
 ♣ 8 6 2

♠ 8 5 2  
 ♥ A 6 5  
 ♦ K J  
 ♣ K Q 10 9 4

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ K Q J 9 3  
 ♥ 4 2  
 ♦ 9 7 6 2  
 ♣ A 5

♠ A 10 4  
 ♥ K 9 8  
 ♦ A Q 8 4  
 ♣ J 7 3

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          | 1 ♣   | 1 ♠  | 2NT   |
| Pass     | 3NT   |      |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

3NT by South

Lead: ♠ 7

♥Q lead would have beaten the contract, partner will not blame you in the least. But if you lead the ♥Q and it turns out that a ♠ lead would have let you set the contract, well, that would not be too good for partnership harmony.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♠ 7, the suit your partner overcalled.

If partner had not overcalled, the ♥Q would be the perfect lead against 3NT. But partner DID overcall, perhaps to give you a hint on what to lead if South became declarer.

As you see, a ♠ lead will defeat the contract this time while the ♥Q would let declarer make 11 tricks.

Consider this: even if partner has a high ♥ to help you establish the suit it is not very likely that you would be able to get the lead with your entryless hand.

There is another, more subtle, reason for leading partner's suit. If the lead turns out wrong, and the ♥Q lead would have beaten the contract, partner will not blame you in the least. But if you lead the ♥Q and it turns out that a ♠ lead would have let you set the contract, well, that would not be too good for partnership harmony.

**Board 4**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 8 4  
♥ A Q 10 7  
♦ K Q 9 8  
♣ 5

♠ 6 5 2

♥ 9 5 3 2

♦ A 6 4

♣ 9 4 2



♠ K 7

♥ 8 6 4

♦ J 7 2

♣ K Q J 10 8

♠ A J 9 3

♥ K J

♦ 10 5 3

♣ A 7 6 3

West

North

East

South

1♣

Dbl

All Pass

1♣X by South

Lead: ♣5

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 1♣  
doubled

Lead the ♣5.

There is only one reason partner would pass your  
takeout double - he has a great ♣ suit and he expects  
to inflict a large penalty.

What he wants do do is pull South's trumps so your  
high card winners don't get ruffed by South. The way  
you can help him do that is to start with a trump lead.

With the trump lead South might not make more than  
three tricks.